Day Zero Policy
Final Placements 2026

Career Development Office, Ashoka University

Day Zero Window	Preference Sheet Closes	Offers Released	Rolling Placements From
5–7 Oct	3 Oct	7 Oct	8 Oct

1. What Day Zero Is

Day Zero is one placement window spread across three days: **5, 6 and 7 October 2026**. Every company slotted in this window is on equal footing.

The day and slot a company gets carries no ranking. Slotting exists purely to run around 30 processes without clashing panels, rooms and student schedules. A company interviewing on 7 October is not "below" one interviewing on 5 October.

What decides your outcome is your **preference sheet**, not when a company happens to interview.

2. The Preference Sheet

Before Day Zero begins you submit one preference sheet ranking the companies you are in the running for. The sheet closes 48 hours before Day Zero opens, **3 October 2026**, and no changes are accepted after that.

Two things to be clear about

- **You may interview everywhere.** Shortlisted at eight companies? Sit all eight. The preference sheet does not restrict where you interview; it only tells us what to do if more than one of them says yes.
- **Rank in the order you actually want.** Your preference sheet is the only instruction we have. We will not call to check whether you meant it.

Rank every company you have applied to or been shortlisted by. Any company you leave off the sheet is a company you are telling us you do not want an offer from.

3. How Offers Are Held and Allocated

No offer reaches you during Day Zero. Companies share their results with the CDO as they finish, and the CDO holds every offer until the end of 7 October.

This applies even to companies that wrap up early. If a firm closes its process on 5 October, its results sit with us until Day Zero ends.

At the close of 7 October, each student is matched to the highest-ranked company on their sheet that made them an offer. That single offer is then released to you.

1. Preference sheet closes, 3 October
2. Interviews across 5–7 October
3. Companies send results to the CDO
4. CDO holds all offers
5. End of 7 October: each student matched to their highest-ranked offer
6. **One offer released to each student**

You will not be told which other companies offered you a role. Only the allocated offer is disclosed, to you and to the company you are matched with.

4. Worked Example

A student is shortlisted at five companies and submits this sheet:

Preference	1	2	3	4	5
Company	Meesho	Kearney	Deloitte USI	INDmoney	D. E. Shaw

They interview at all five across 5–7 October. What they receive at the end of 7 October depends only on who said yes:

Companies that made an offer	Offer released	Student is told about
Kearney, Deloitte USI, D. E. Shaw	**Kearney**	Kearney only
Deloitte USI, D. E. Shaw	**Deloitte USI**	Deloitte USI only
Meesho, D. E. Shaw	**Meesho**	Meesho only
D. E. Shaw only	**D. E. Shaw**	D. E. Shaw
None	No offer; moves to rolling placements from 8 October	–

In row one, D. E. Shaw may have finished interviewing and cleared the student on 5 October. It makes no difference: Kearney sits higher on the sheet, so Kearney is the offer, and the student never learns the other two said yes.

5. After Day Zero: 8 October Onwards

From 8 October the process switches to rolling placements. There is no preference sheet and no holding of offers.

Companies run in the order they are slotted, and the first offer you receive is the one you take: offer and out, the standard rule for any Category 1 company. Once you are placed, you are out of the process for every company that follows.

This is why slot order matters after Day Zero and does not matter during it.